

Project 1: The Agency Founder's Blueprint

Unit 1: Foundations | Chapter 1: The Developer's World

Project Objective

Welcome to the Guild. You are no longer just a student; you are a founding member of the **Carson High Web Design & Marketing Agency**. Before we write a single line of code for local Carson City clients, we must lay the foundation of our business. A brilliant coder without a plan is just someone typing in the dark.

Your goal is to apply professional soft skills, industry terminology, and business logic to establish your role and business strategy within the agency. By the end of this project, you will have written your business plan's executive summary, secured our digital real estate, negotiated with a simulated client, and written our ethical Code of Conduct.

Project Milestones & Employability Focus

Milestone 1: The Job Application (The "Who")

Focus: Professional Decorum (WRS 1.1.4) & Career Pathways (NV 1.1)

Goal: Identify your optimal career pathway and demonstrate professional team communication.

Action: Review the open positions (Intern, Junior Dev, Senior Dev, UX Designer, Project Manager). Write a professional cover letter for your chosen role. Then, draft a response to a team conflict scenario between a designer and developer using CTSO parliamentary procedure logic.

Deliverable: A 3-to-5 sentence professional cover letter and a conflict resolution paragraph.

Milestone 2: The Business Plan (The "Target")

Focus: Entrepreneurship & Critical Thinking (WRS 1.2.3)

Goal: Define the agency's target audience and service offerings within the local market.

Action: Write the Executive Summary of your business plan. Decide on a specific agency niche (e.g., e-commerce for downtown retail, or organizational sites for state non-profits) based on website types (Personal, Organizational, Topical, Commercial).

Deliverable: A 1-page Business Plan Executive Summary outlining the target Carson City market, website types offered, and the agency's core mission.

Milestone 3: Digital Real Estate (The "Where")

Focus: Analytical Reasoning (WRS 1.2.3) & Infrastructure Concepts (NV 6.1.2)

Goal: Secure the agency's web presence and architect a scalable hosting solution.

Action: Select a unique domain name (e.g., carsoncreative.com) and decode its parts. Explain how the DNS (Domain Name System) routes users to it. Next, propose a hosting solution for a high-traffic client using CDNs and HTTPS/SSL.

Deliverable: A domain breakdown map and a scalable hosting proposal document.

Milestone 4: Client Expectations (The "How")

Focus: Problem Solving (WRS 1.2.3) & Client Communication (WRS 1.1.4)

Goal: Negotiate project scope using professional industry frameworks without alienating the client.

Action: A boutique owner wants a 50-page e-commerce site by Friday for \$100. Use the "Project Triangle" (Fast, Good, Cheap) to explain why this is impossible in a professional email.

Deliverable: A professional email response offering a Minimum Viable Product (MVP) alternative.

Milestone 5: The Code of Conduct (The "Rules")

Focus: Integrity (WRS 1.1.2), Inclusive Collaboration (WRS 1.1.5), Legal Compliance (NV 2.1)

Goal: Establish ethical, accessible, and legally compliant agency standards.

Action: Create a strict 3-point employee checklist covering file naming conventions (index.html), intellectual property, and the "Curb Cut Effect." Then, draft a corporate policy banning "Dark Patterns" and mandating web accessibility.

Deliverable: The Agency Rules checklist and the comprehensive Ethics Policy.



Grading Rubric & Proficiency Scale (100 pts)



Proficiency Scale: The Agency Founder's Blueprint

(Targets: NV 6.1.1, 6.1.2, 5.6.1, 6.2.1, 4.3.1, 5.1, 5.2 | WRS 1.1.4, 1.1.2, 1.1.5, 1.2.3)

Score	Performance Indicators
4.0 (Advanced)	Digital Architect: Synthesizes market research into a highly targeted business plan. Architect a scalable hosting solution (CDNs/SSL) for the agency. Drafts a comprehensive digital ethics policy (WCAG/Dark Patterns) and demonstrates high-level leadership in the CTSO conflict scenario.
3.0 (Mastery)	Practitioner: Accurately defines the agency's target market and aligns it with correct website types. Traces the DNS lookup sequence. Applies rules of copyright and secure file naming (index.html). Applies the "Project Triangle" to a client scenario.
2.0 (Foundational)	Apprentice: Defines common terminology (DNS, URL, MVP, Soft Skills, Website Types). Identifies the importance of professional decorum, copyright, and accessibility, but requires guidance to successfully apply these concepts to the business plan and client scenarios.
1.0 (Novice)	Beginner: Attempted the project, but relies heavily on basic definitions. Major errors persist regarding the business plan strategy, the project triangle, or file naming rules.



Detailed Point Breakdown

1. The Job Application (20 pts)

- **4.0 (Advanced / 20 pts) - Digital Architect:** Flawless cover letter using precise industry vocabulary. CTSO conflict resolution paragraph demonstrates deep understanding of professional parliamentary procedure and teamwork.
- **3.0 (Mastery / 17 pts) - Practitioner:** Cover letter is professional and accurately defines the role. Conflict resolution is logical but may lack formal CTSO procedure references.
- **2.0 (Foundational / 14 pts) - Apprentice:** Identifies a role but justification is brief or uses informal language. Struggles with the conflict resolution scenario.

- **1.0 (Novice / 10 pts) - Beginner:** Role is missing, completely misunderstood, or written unprofessionally.

2. The Business Plan (20 pts)

- **4.0 (Advanced / 20 pts) - Digital Architect:** Executive summary is highly professional, identifies a specific Carson City market niche, and perfectly justifies the chosen website types (Commercial, Organizational, etc.).
- **3.0 (Mastery / 17 pts) - Practitioner:** Clearly outlines a target market and lists the correct website types the agency will offer.
- **2.0 (Foundational / 14 pts) - Apprentice:** Vague business plan that struggles to connect the agency services to a specific target audience or incorrectly identifies website types.
- **1.0 (Novice / 10 pts) - Beginner:** Missing executive summary or complete misunderstanding of the target market.

3. Digital Real Estate (20 pts)

- **4.0 (Advanced / 20 pts) - Digital Architect:** Perfectly decodes the URL. DNS explanation is technically accurate. Hosting proposal effectively synthesizes CDNs, SSL, and scalable cloud logic for viral traffic.
- **3.0 (Mastery / 17 pts) - Practitioner:** URL is decoded correctly. DNS process is explained well. Identifies hosting needs but lacks depth on CDNs or elasticity.
- **2.0 (Foundational / 14 pts) - Apprentice:** Can define IP, Domain, and URL, but struggles to connect them into a coherent DNS trace or hosting proposal.
- **1.0 (Novice / 10 pts) - Beginner:** Major misconceptions about the difference between the Internet, the Web, and web hosting.

4. Client Expectations (20 pts)

- **4.0 (Advanced / 20 pts) - Digital Architect:** Email is highly professional, perfectly applying the Project Triangle (Fast, Good, Cheap) without offending the client. MVP alternative is realistic and clearly defined.
- **3.0 (Mastery / 17 pts) - Practitioner:** Correctly uses the Project Triangle to explain the problem. Tone is appropriate. An MVP is suggested.
- **2.0 (Foundational / 14 pts) - Apprentice:** Understands the project triangle but the email tone is unprofessional or the MVP concept is missing/incorrect.
- **1.0 (Novice / 10 pts) - Beginner:** Fails to use the Project Triangle logic to solve the client scenario.

5. The Code of Conduct (20 pts)

- **4.0 (Advanced / 20 pts) - Digital Architect:** 3-point checklist is perfectly accurate (index.html, strict lowercase/no spaces). Ethics policy demonstrates profound probity, accurately citing WCAG standards and the dangers of Dark Patterns.
- **3.0 (Mastery / 17 pts) - Practitioner:** Checklist covers file rules and copyright correctly. Ethics policy addresses accessibility but may miss deeper nuances like the Curb Cut effect.
- **2.0 (Foundational / 14 pts) - Apprentice:** Identifies file naming rules but misses copyright

distinctions. Understands accessibility basically but cannot articulate WCAG or Dark Pattern concepts.

- **1.0 (Novice / 10 pts) - Beginner:** Major errors in file naming rules (e.g., allows spaces/capitals in examples) and missing ethical guidelines.